

READER &amp; SUBSCRIBER HELP · REVIEW, CONCEPT &amp; BUSINESS CASE

# Every reader, to the **right place**, first time.

How one reChanneld front door can serve Reach's growing subscriber base across reachplc.com and 19+ subscription brands, with no redesign, no new systems, and a measurable 8-week pilot.

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Reach today & why now

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Concept on your site  
(separate PDF)

# Dear George and the Reach Customer team,

Reach has done something few publishers manage: more than 50,000 paying digital subscribers in under nine months, on top of 65,000+ print, e-edition and newsletter subscribers. With 25 brands selling subscriptions by October and a new Customer division bringing print and digital together, **readers are fast becoming customers**, and customers have questions.

We looked at where those questions go today. reachplc.com/contacts serves a dozen audiences with **eight phone numbers, six e-mail addresses and five other websites**. Its only form is for investors, and it has no route for digital subscribers at all. On the print side, Reachsubs scores 2.5/5 on Trustpilot, and the reviews describe missed papers, unexplained direct-debit increases and phones nobody answers.

reChanneld is channel-strategy software from Helsinki. Its plug-and-play widget asks visitors what they need and shows them the best channel for it, with self-service first and honest opening hours and waiting times. It sits on top of the pages and systems you already have.

This pack contains:

**1**

## **Audit**

Every contact route on reachplc.com mapped by audience, plus 8 findings.

**2**

## **Concept**

The real reChanneld widget on your real pages, configured with Reach's own topics.

**3**

## **Business case**

A cost model, readiness for the 2027 subscription rules, and an 8-week pilot.

We'd welcome 20 minutes with you or the subscriptions team to walk through it.

Kind regards,

**Touko Laakkonen**

Service Channel Strategy, reChanneld · [e-mail] · [phone]

# From audience scale to paying customers

The UK's largest commercial national and regional news publisher is moving its centre of gravity from page views to subscribers.

**£232.9 M**

H1 2026 revenue (-9%)

**76%**

of revenue still from print  
(£178 M)

**-55%**

Google referrals, H1 2026  
vs H1 2025

**-10%**

adjusted operating costs,  
H1 2026

**50,000+**

paid digital subscribers (Aug  
2026), target 75,000 by  
year-end

**65,000+**

print, e-edition and paid  
newsletter subscribers

**19 → 25**

brands selling subscriptions,  
by October

**£1.99–6.99**

a month, e.g. Mirror+ £3.99,  
MEN £4.99, Express £6.99

## 2026 so far

- **Mar** FY 2025: revenue £518.4 M, adjusted operating profit up 2.4% to £104.7 M. Priorities: video, tech & AI, and subscriptions.
- **Q2** Print volumes -23%, after another cover-price rise, against a usual 17–20% decline.
- **Jun** George Grist named Chief Customer Officer of a new Customer division covering print circulation, digital subscriptions, e-commerce and the US business.
- **Jul** H1 results: margin up to 18.5%; 40,000+ subscribers across 15 brands.
- **Aug** 50,000 paid digital subscribers in under nine months. Bundles across national and local brands in development.
- **Sep** Editorial restructure. “Active engaged time” becomes the north-star metric instead of page views.

## What this means for reader help

- **More customers, more questions.** Every new subscriber brings log-in, billing and plan questions. Contact volumes grow with success.
- **Two customer bases, one division.** Print customers (deliveries, vouchers, direct debits) and digital customers (log-in, ad-lite, plans) now sit under one Customer team.
- **Price rises create contacts.** Cover-price and subscription increases bring “why did my payment go up?” questions, and those affect churn.
- **Costs must keep falling.** Contacts need to be handled better without adding staff.

**The opportunity:** give every subscriber a clear front door now, while the subscriber base is still being built.

# Four reasons to act this quarter

1

## Subscribers are becoming the business

The goal is 75,000 digital subscribers by year-end and “more into 2027”, with bundles on the way. Keeping subscribers is now as important as winning them, and every frustrated contact is a churn risk.

2

## A new Customer division is being built

Print circulation, digital subscriptions and e-commerce have just come together under one Chief Customer Officer. This is the moment to design a single front door, before each brand and team builds its own.

3

## New UK subscription rules from January 2027

The DMCC Act's subscription regime requires straightforward cancellation, cooling-off periods and renewal reminders. Clear, honest help routes, including how to cancel, are becoming a compliance matter, not just good service.

4

## Costs are falling, and the readers who remain matter more

Operating costs are down 10% and print volumes are falling faster after price rises. Self-service has to carry more of the load, without leaving loyal, often older, print readers stranded.

## Who this is for

Executive sponsor

### George Grist

Chief Customer Officer, since June 2026

Owns print circulation and digital subscriptions together. reChanneld gives his new division one front door and one shared view of what readers need.

Subscriptions growth

### David Bartlett

Head of Growth (to confirm)

Is launching bundles and paid newsletters. reChanneld routes plan-change and upgrade questions to the right offer.

Print customers

### Circulation / Reachsubs lead

Find on LinkedIn

Missed papers, vouchers and direct debits. These are the highest-volume, most fixable contacts.

Corporate site owner

### Corporate communications

reachplc.com

The contacts page serves a dozen audiences. A single widget tidies it up without a redesign.

# reachplc.com/contacts, line by line

Every contact route on the page on 2 October 2026, grouped by who it's for.

| AUDIENCE                         | ROUTE TODAY                                                       | WHAT WE NOTICED                                                     |
|----------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Print subscriber (vouchers)      | help@newspapersubs.co.uk · 0345 144 6464 · newspapersubs.co.uk    | Three routes, and a different brand name                            |
| Print subscriber (home delivery) | 0333 202 8000                                                     | Phone only, hours not shown                                         |
| Digital subscriber               | No route on the page                                              | 50,000+ customers with nowhere to go                                |
| Reader with a story or tip       | "Contact the newspaper or title directly via their website"       | Sends people away to 120+ brand sites                               |
| Reader with a complaint          | reachplc.com/how-to-complain                                      | Fine, but mixed in with other routes                                |
| Advertiser                       | Reachsolutions.co.uk (listed twice)                               | Clear, but repeated                                                 |
| Licensing buyer                  | mirrorpix.com · 01923 815 121                                     | OK                                                                  |
| Journalist / media               | communications@reachplc.com                                       | OK                                                                  |
| Job seeker                       | talentacquisition@reachplc.com                                    | OK                                                                  |
| Book PR                          | mirrorbooks@reachplc.com                                          | OK                                                                  |
| Supplier                         | company.secretary@reachplc.com                                    | Whistleblowing only                                                 |
| Investor                         | Online form (the only form on the page)                           | The best-served audience                                            |
| Shareholder                      | Equiniti: 0371 384 2235 · +44 121 415 7047 · Textel 0371 384 2255 | Three numbers                                                       |
| Pensioner                        | 020 7293 2050 · pensions@reachplc.com                             | OK                                                                  |
| Anyone else                      | Switchboard 020 7293 3000                                         | The default for anyone unsure, which means the most expensive route |

8 phone numbers · 6 e-mail addresses · 5 other websites · 1 form · 0 routes for digital subscribers. The visitor does all the routing.

## 8 findings

2/10

DIGITAL SUBSCRIBER  
HELP

3/10

CLEAR ROUTING

4/10

PRINT SUBSCRIBER  
HELP

5/10

OPENING HOURS  
SHOWN

8/10

INVESTOR & B2B  
ROUTES

### 01 No route for digital subscribers **CRITICAL**

The fastest-growing customer group, over 50,000 people paying £1.99–6.99 a month, isn't mentioned on the group contacts page.

→ A “My digital subscription” topic: log-in, billing, ad-lite and plan changes.

### 02 The visitor has to do the routing **CRITICAL**

Twenty routes for a dozen audiences on one long page. Anyone unsure calls the switchboard.

→ One question first: “What can we help with?”, then only the routes that apply.

### 03 Print subscribers report missed papers and unanswered phones **HIGH**

Reachsubs scores 2.5/5 on Trustpilot. Reviews mention papers missing two or three times a week, direct debits rising by about 10% without explanation, calls cut off, and e-mails unanswered for a month.

→ Route “paper didn't arrive” and “why did my payment change?” to instant self-service and clear explanations first.

### 04 Three subscription brands, one customer **HIGH**

Reach, Newspapersubs and Reachsubs all appear. Readers don't know which one manages their subscription.

→ The widget asks about the reader's subscription, not about Reach's internal brands.

### 05 No opening hours or waiting times **MEDIUM**

None of the subscriber phone lines show when they're open or how busy they are.

→ Show today's hours and the typical waiting time on every phone option.

### 06 Price-rise questions have no home **MEDIUM**

Three cover-price rises in 2025 and more in 2026 mean many “why did I pay more?” contacts.

→ A “Direct debit or price” topic, with a clear explanation first and a person second.

### 07 Cancellation isn't signposted **MEDIUM**

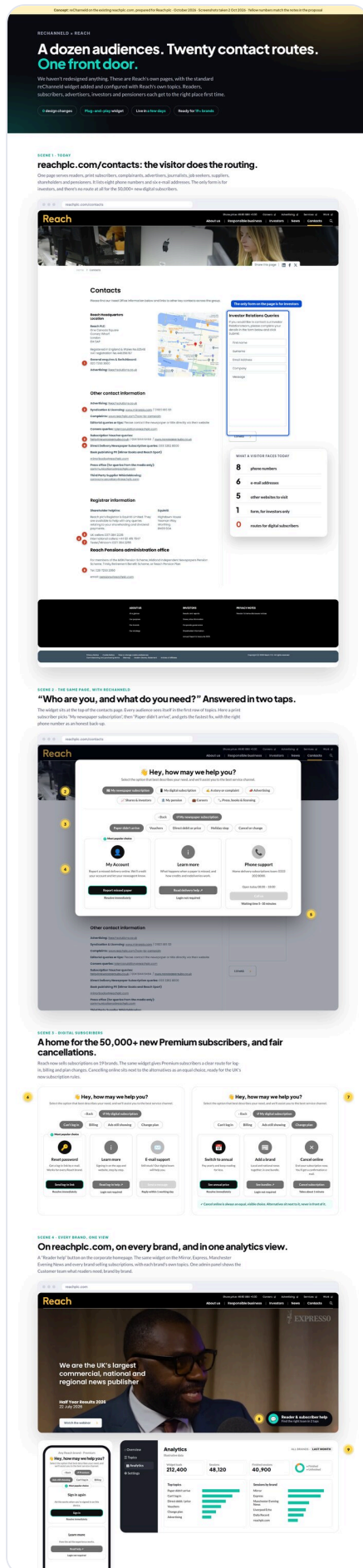
From January 2027, UK rules require subscriptions to be easy to cancel. There's no visible route on the page today.

→ “Cancel or change” as an equal choice, with pause and switch options next to it.

### 08 No insight into what readers need **LOW**

With routes spread across phones, inboxes and other sites, nobody sees the full picture of contact reasons.

→ One analytics view: topics, channels and brands, in real time.



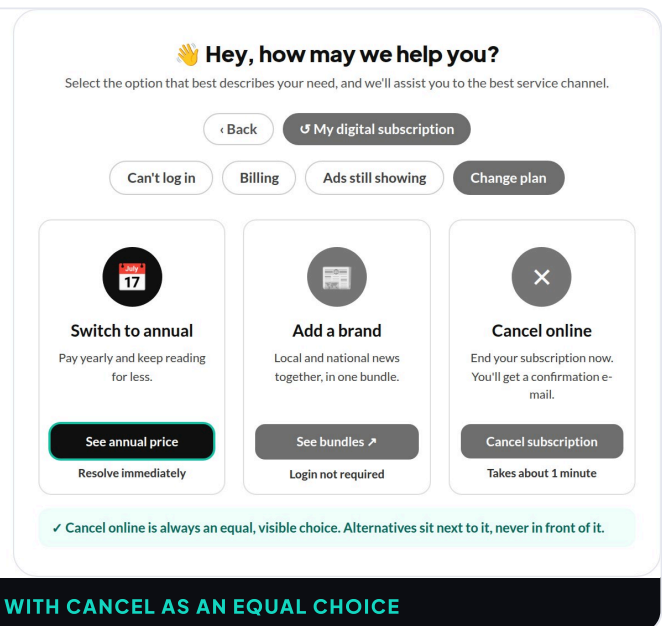
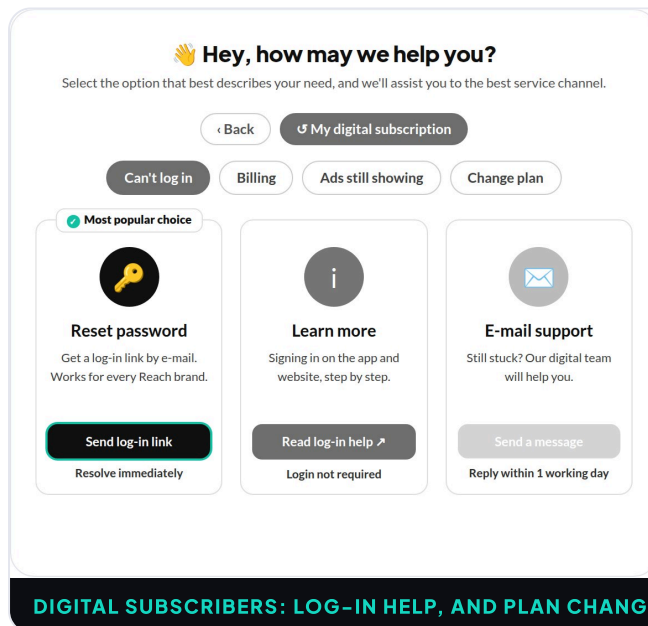
# Your pages, exactly as they are. Plus one front door.

Screenshots of reachplc.com as it is today, with the standard reChannelled widget added and configured with Reach's own topics. The full page is in **reChannelled-Reach-Concept.pdf**, and each yellow number matches a note below.

- 1 Today:** 8 phone numbers, 6 e-mail addresses, 5 other websites and 1 investor form, with no route for digital subscribers. Findings 01 and 02.
- 2 First question: who are you?** Eight first-level topics cover every audience on the page: newspaper subscription, digital subscription, story or complaint, advertising, investors, pension, careers, press.
- 3 Then: what do you need?** Sub-topics such as Paper didn't arrive, Vouchers, Direct debit or price, Holiday stop and Cancel or change. Findings 03, 04 and 06.
- 4 "Most popular choice"**. Self-service is highlighted first, here "Report missed paper", marked "Resolve immediately".
- 5 Phone, honestly.** The right number for that need, with today's opening hours and the typical waiting time. Finding 05.
- 6 Digital subscribers get a home.** Can't log in, billing, ads still showing and change plan, valid for every Reach brand. Finding 01.
- 7 Change plan, fairly.** Switch to annual, add a brand (bundles), or cancel online as an equal choice. Finding 07, ready for 2027.
- 8 A "Reader & subscriber help" button** on the reachplc.com homepage, which today speaks only to investors and partners.
- 9 Every brand, one analytics view.** The same widget on the Mirror, Express, MEN and others, with sessions, topics and brands in one place. Finding 08.
- 10 What changes:** no design changes, a plug-and-play widget, live in a few days, GDPR compliant with no cookies.

## Why no redesign

reachplc.com is a well-built corporate site for many audiences. reChannelled adds the missing customer path on top, so it can go live in days and expand brand by brand.



# Proposed starting configuration

Eight first-level topics, each with sub-topics and a recommended channel. Built from public information; in a pilot, your own contact data decides the final structure and wording.



## My newspaper subscription

|                       |                 |
|-----------------------|-----------------|
| Paper didn't arrive   | Self-service    |
| Vouchers              | Self-service    |
| Direct debit or price | Article – phone |
| Holiday stop          | Self-service    |
| Cancel or change      | Options, equal  |



## My digital subscription

|                      |                |
|----------------------|----------------|
| Can't log in         | Self-service   |
| Billing              | My Account     |
| Ads still showing    | Article        |
| Change plan / bundle | Self-service   |
| Cancel               | Options, equal |



## A story or complaint

|                       |                     |
|-----------------------|---------------------|
| I have a story or tip | Brand newsdesk form |
| Correct an article    | Complaints form     |
| Formal complaint      | How to complain     |
| Remove my details     | Form → team         |



## Advertising

|                         |                 |
|-------------------------|-----------------|
| Advertise nationally    | Reach Solutions |
| Local business ad       | Reach Solutions |
| Notices (family, legal) | Brand page      |
| Licensing & photos      | Mirrorpix       |



## Shares & investors

|                    |                |
|--------------------|----------------|
| My shareholding    | Equiniti       |
| Results & reports  | Investor pages |
| Investor relations | IR form        |



## My pension

|                             |                |
|-----------------------------|----------------|
| Scheme information          | Pension pages  |
| Contact the pensions office | E-mail → phone |



## Careers

|                      |              |
|----------------------|--------------|
| Current vacancies    | Careers site |
| Application question | E-mail       |



## Press, books & other

|                            |                   |
|----------------------------|-------------------|
| Media enquiry              | Press office      |
| Mirror Books / Reach Sport | E-mail            |
| Supplier whistleblowing    | Company secretary |
| Something else             | Switchboard       |

### Several configurations

One configuration for reachplc.com covers all audiences. Brand sites such as the Mirror, Express and MEN get a reader-only configuration with that brand's own subscription topics.

### Managed by the Customer team

Topics, texts, buttons, hours and the “Most popular choice” are edited in reChanneld's cloud admin panel and change instantly, without IT tickets or releases.

# Easy to cancel, still good at keeping

From January 2027 the UK's new subscription contracts regime, under the Digital Markets, Competition and Consumers Act 2024, applies to subscriptions like Reach's.

## What the regime requires (in summary)

- **Easy exit.** Consumers can end a contract with a clear statement, without unnecessary steps.
- **Cooling-off.** A 14-day cooling-off period at the start, and again after renewal.
- **Reminders.** Notices before renewals and before a free or discounted period ends.
- **Consequences.** Missing duties can give consumers the right to cancel and claim refunds.

A summary based on public guidance, not legal advice. Your legal team will have the details.

## How a front door helps

- **Cancel is visible.** “Cancel or change” is a standard topic on every brand, never hidden.
- **Equal choices.** Pause, switch to annual or add a brand appear next to cancel, not in front of it, so retention stays fair.
- **Reminder follow-up.** Renewal e-mails link to the widget's “My renewal” topic, so questions land in self-service, not the phone queue.
- **Evidence.** Analytics show how many people chose each option, which helps the Customer team show the journey works.

**Hey, how may we help you?**

Select the option that best describes your need, and we'll assist you to the best service channel.

Back

My digital subscription

Can't log in

Billing

Ads still showing

Change plan

Most popular choice

**Reset password**  
 Get a log-in link by e-mail. Works for every Reach brand.
 

Send log-in link

 Resolve immediately

**Learn more**  
 Signing in on the app and website, step by step.
 

Read log-in help

 Login not required

**E-mail support**  
 Still stuck? Our digital team will help you.
 

Send a message

 Reply within 1 working day

**Hey, how may we help you?**

Select the option that best describes your need, and we'll assist you to the best service channel.

Back

My digital subscription

Can't log in

Billing

Ads still showing

Change plan

**Switch to annual**  
 Pay yearly and keep reading for less.
 

See annual price

 Resolve immediately

**Add a brand**  
 Local and national news together, in one bundle.
 

See bundles

 Login not required

**Cancel online**  
 End your subscription now. You'll get a confirmation e-mail.
 

Cancel subscription

 Takes about 1 minute

**Retention by service, not by friction: readers who only wanted a break or a cheaper plan find it in one tap, and those who want to leave can.**

# A simple cost model to fill in together

We don't know Reach's contact volumes, so this is a worked example with clearly stated assumptions. In the first call we'd replace them with your real figures.

| ASSUMPTION                                                          | EXAMPLE          |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|
| Subscribers (digital 75k target + 65k print, e-edition, newsletter) | <b>140,000</b>   |
| Contacts per subscriber per year                                    | <b>0.4</b>       |
| Subscriber contacts per year                                        | <b>56,000</b>    |
| Share moved to self-service by nudging                              | <b>30%</b>       |
| Contacts avoided per year                                           | <b>16,800</b>    |
| Cost per assisted contact (reChanneld's ROI basis: €5)              | <b>≈ £4.30</b>   |
| <b>Annual saving, subscriber contacts only</b>                      | <b>≈ £72,000</b> |

Excludes switchboard, advertiser and investor routing, retention effects and the value of agent time freed for complex cases.

## Where the value comes from

- **Fewer assisted contacts.** Missed papers, log-in and billing questions move to self-service.
- **Faster help for those who call.** Shorter queues for complex cases and readers who need a person.
- **Lower avoidable churn.** Frustrated subscribers leave. A fixed problem keeps the subscription.
- **Insight.** Real-time data on what readers need, by brand, for the Customer and product teams.

## reChanneld's own benchmark

On reChanneld's published plans, ROI is reached by nudging around 5% of traffic, assuming €5 per contact. Clients typically see 79% of channel selections go to self-service, automation and leads.

**Retention matters more than savings: at £4.99 a month, every 1,000 subscribers kept is worth about £60,000 a year.**

# Prove it on two pages, with your own data

Suggested scope: [reachplc.com/contacts](https://reachplc.com/contacts) (all audiences) and the Manchester Evening News, Reach's first Premium brand, for digital and print subscribers.

## WEEKS 1–2

### Map

Review three months of contact reasons from Reachsubs and digital support. Agree topics, channels and wording, and set the baseline. The widget can be live within days.

## WEEKS 3–8

### Guide

Widget live on both pages, linked from subscriber e-mails. Wording and recommended channels adjusted weekly from the analytics.

## WEEK 9

### Decide

Review results together, then a brand-by-brand rollout plan for the remaining subscription brands.

## What we'll measure

| KPI                                          | HOW                         |
|----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| Calls and e-mails per 1,000 subscribers      | Your data, before vs during |
| Switchboard calls                            | Your data, before vs during |
| Top channels chosen per topic                | reChanneld analytics        |
| Finished sessions                            | reChanneld analytics        |
| Cancel-topic choices (pause, switch, cancel) | reChanneld analytics        |
| Trustpilot themes                            | Review trend                |

## Who does what

### reChanneld

- Configuration, topics and copy
- Analytics access and weekly check-ins
- Final report and rollout plan

### Reach

- One Customer-team contact, about 2 hours a week
- Contact-reason data and current help links
- Adding the widget to the two pages

**No redesign, no new chatbot and no change to subscription platforms. If it doesn't show results in 8 weeks, you stop.**

# “Welcome to Premium”: a 40-second onboarding video

Most log-in and “ads still showing” contacts happen in a subscriber's first week. A short welcome video in the confirmation e-mail and app shows how to sign in on every device and where to get help, before the questions start. It's made once, with an end card for each brand.

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p>0:00–0:06</p> <p> <b>“You're in!”</b><br/>Brand logo + Premium badge</p> <p><b>VISUAL</b><br/>A confirmation screen lights up.<br/><i>“Welcome to Premium. Thanks for backing local journalism.”</i></p>                 | <p>0:06–0:16</p> <p> <b>Sign in once on each device</b></p> <p><b>VISUAL</b><br/>Phone, laptop and tablet each show the sign-in.<br/><i>“Sign in on each device you use, and the ad-lite experience follows you.”</i></p> | <p>0:16–0:24</p> <p> <b>Ad-lite · exclusives · newsletters</b></p> <p><b>VISUAL</b><br/>A quick tour of the benefits.<br/><i>“Fewer ads, exclusive stories, and newsletters made for you.”</i></p> |
| <p>0:24–0:32</p> <p> <b>“Hey, how may we help you?”</b></p> <p><b>VISUAL</b><br/>The reChanneld widget opens: Can't log in → Send log-in link.<br/><i>“Any questions? Our help button gets you sorted in seconds.”</i></p> | <p>0:32–0:36</p> <p> <b>Your plan, your choice</b></p> <p><b>VISUAL</b><br/>Change plan: annual, bundle, or cancel.<br/><i>“Change or cancel any time. It's all in one place.”</i></p>                                  | <p>0:36–0:40</p> <p><b>[Brand] Premium Help: one tap away</b></p> <p><b>VISUAL</b><br/>End card in the brand's colours.<br/><i>“Enjoy reading.”</i></p>                                                                                                                               |

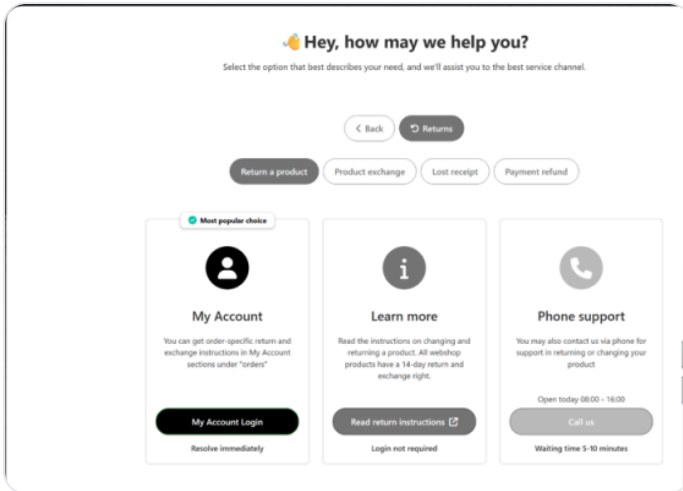
## Formats

9:16 for the app and social, 16:9 for web, plus a GIF and a 15-second cut for e-mails. Captioned throughout.

## One master, 25 brands

Voice-over and end cards adapt per brand: Mirror+, Express Premium, MEN Premium, Echo, Record and more.

# Better choices. Happier customers. Lower costs.



The reChanneld widget as it works today: topic, sub-topic, channel cards and the “Most popular choice”.

reChanneld is a channel strategy platform from Helsinki, Finland. A plug-and-play widget uses behavioural economics and digital nudges to guide customers to the best service channel. Customer service teams manage it themselves in a cloud admin panel, and it works on top of their existing website and channels.

**4M+**

annual sessions

**79%**

channel selections to self-service, automation and leads

**87%**

of end users found reChanneld easy and clear

**Days**

to define and implement a channel strategy

**“Within just a few days we were able to nail our service channel strategy with reChanneld. Nudges work excellently, and we offer a far more intuitive experience to our customers than before!”**

Teresa Alander, Head of Operations, Lippu.fi (part of CTS Eventim)

## Used by

S-Bank, Nets, Lippu.fi, PAM, Sportson, Laurea, Varha and Satakunta wellbeing services county. They cover banking, payments, ticketing, retail, education and the public sector.

## Enterprise-ready

Audited for security and accessibility, GDPR compliant, no cookies. White-labelled for each brand. Enterprise plan with unlimited admin users and integrations.

## Shall we take 20 minutes?

We'd love to hear how reader and subscriber help works today, and where it hurts most.

**Touko Laakkonen**  
reChanneld • [e-mail] • [phone]